

Joel Freeborn

Senior / Lead Product Designer

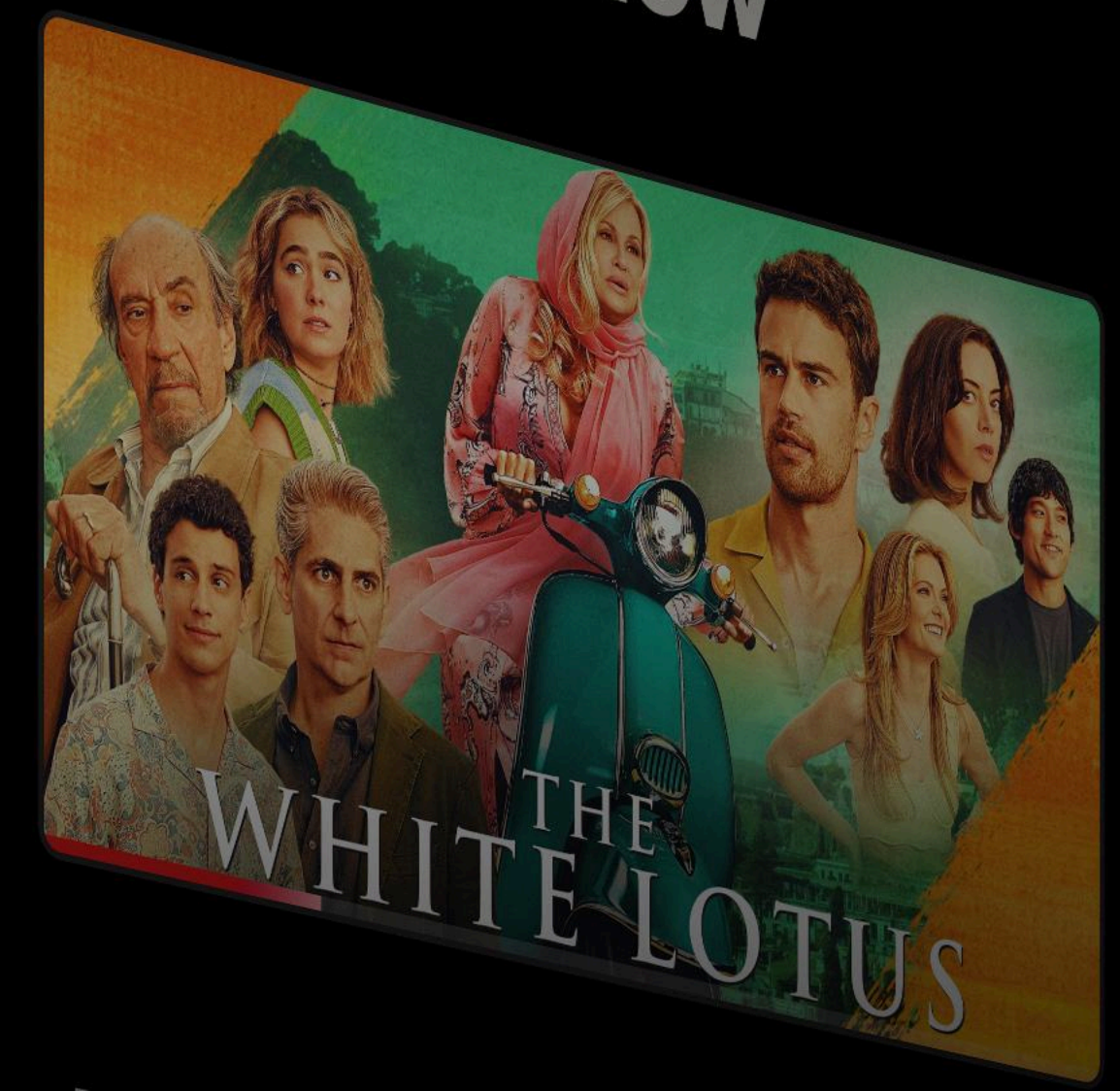


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Search

Home

For you on now



I help teams ship better products faster

Senior / lead product designer specialising in complex, cross-platform products (TV, mobile & web). I combine strategic thinking with hands-on execution - from early problem framing through to shipped UI and QA.

Where I add the most value:

- Simplifying complex multi-platform ecosystems
- Specialist in designing unified experiences across TV, mobile and web interaction models
- Scaling and evolving design systems
- Driving measurable UX improvements (retention, revenue, engagement)
- Embedding closely with product & engineering teams to ship fast

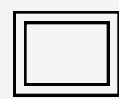
Recent impact:

- Reduced churn by 15% YoY through UX and discovery improvements
- Helped drive 2× ARPU via monetisation-focused design initiatives
- Designed experiences used by millions across TV, mobile and web

verizon



How I work



Framing

Rapidly assess product goals, constraints, and team dynamics.



Simplify

Identify highest-impact opportunities and reduce complexity.



Design & validate

Prototype quickly, test assumptions, iterate with stakeholders.



Ship

Work closely with engineering through delivery and QA.



Evolving Verizon's Fios TV ecosystem

For the past three years, I've been embedded within Verizon's Fios TV ecosystem, evolving experiences across TV, mobile and web products used by over 3 million customers.

Rather than a single redesign, the work focused on continuous optimisation - improving discovery, consistency and delivery speed while scaling design foundations across platforms.



Operating model

I work as a lead product designer embedded directly with product and engineering teams, balancing long-term design system health with fast, incremental product delivery.

How I typically operate:

- Identify high-impact opportunities through product data, feedback and stakeholder input
- Translate complex problems into clear, actionable solutions
- Ship improvements iteratively instead of waiting for large redesign cycles
- Use shared components and system thinking to scale improvements across platforms
- Partner closely with engineers throughout implementation and QA

Iconography

General

- + Plus
- + Watchlist / Inactive
- ✓ Watchlist / Active
- 🔒 Lock / Unlocked
- 🔒 Lock / Locked
- 🔄 Loader

Settings

- 👤 Account
- 📱 Manage Devices
- 📶 Upgrade
- ✂ Tools
- 📺 Viewing
- 🔒 Parental

Chevron

- ⌵ Chevron / Down
- ⏪ Chevron / Left
- ⏩ Chevron / Right
- ⌴ Chevron / Up

Arrow

- ➔ Arrow /
- ⬆ Arrow /
- ⬅ Arrow /
- ⬇ Arrow /

1



2



Variables		Q Search	
Collections	+	Name	Value
.primitives	31	 color-palette-red	 EE001E
color / shared	12	 color-palette-white-92	 EBEbeb
color / tv	33	 color-palette-white-100	 FFFFFFFF
color / web & app	65	 color-palette-black	 000000
radius	5	 color-palette-gray-11	 1D1C1C
typography	23	 color-palette-gray-44	 716F6D
Groups			
All	31		

Scope of ownership

- Continuous UX optimisation
- Cross-platform consistency
- Design system governance and evolution
- Feature innovation and experimentation
- Improving collaboration between design, product and engineering

Impact highlights

- Reduced churn by 15% YoY through UX and discovery improvements
- Helped drive 2× ARPU through monetisation-focused design initiatives
- Unified patterns across six platforms
- Improved delivery efficiency through scalable design system practices

Key initiatives

- Reducing decision fatigue in content discovery (see 'Quick Picks' deep dive next)
- Cross-platform navigation improvements
- Design system restructuring and scaling
- Monetisation and bundling UX enhancements



Quick Picks - reducing decision fatigue in TV content discovery

Content discovery was one of the biggest friction points within the Fios TV ecosystem. Discovery patterns often relied on endless scrolling and filtering - increasing effort instead of reducing it.

I led the product design exploration and interaction model definition for the Quick Picks innovation.

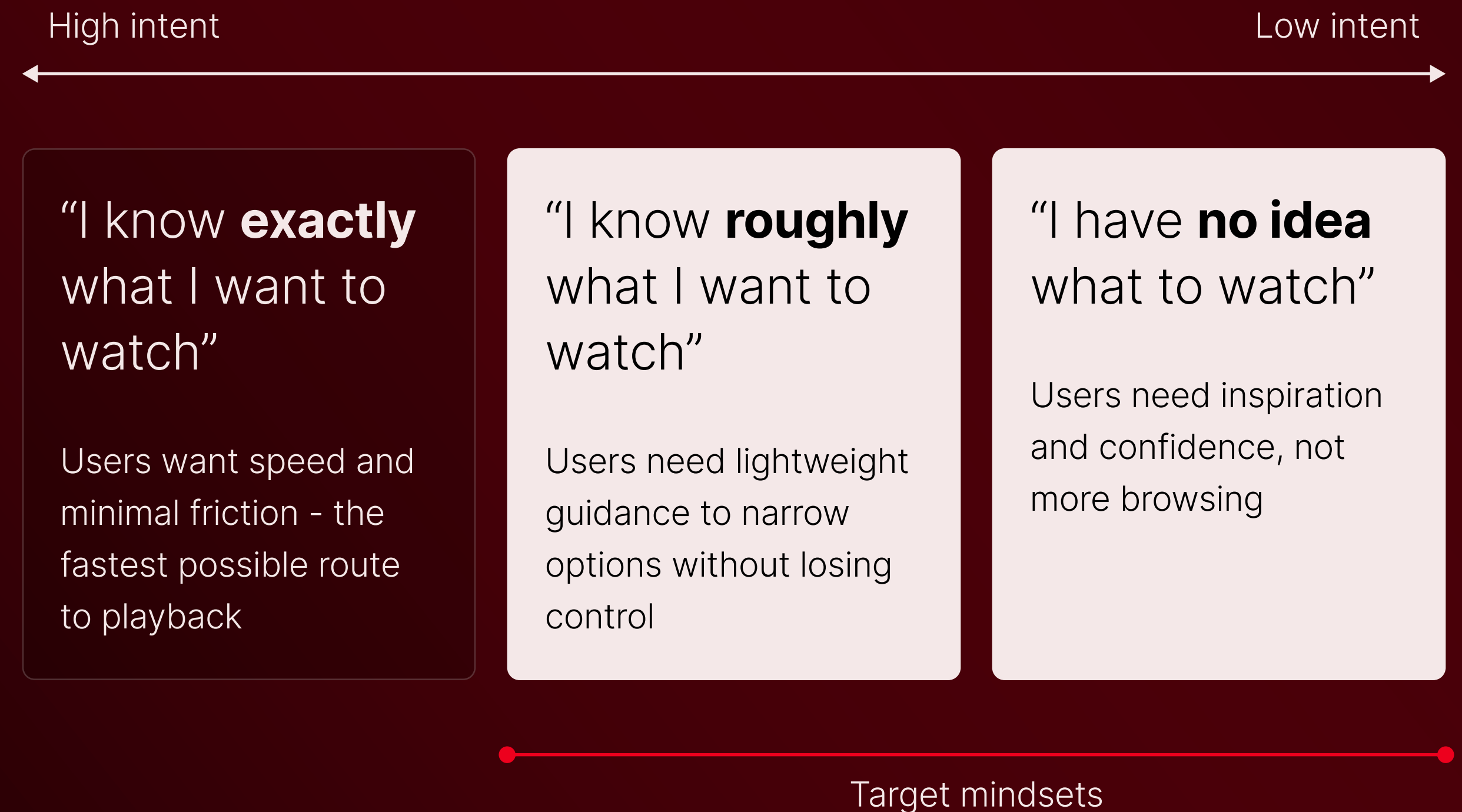


Insight - users arrive in different decision states

Typical discovery models assume users follow a single browsing journey.

In reality, users arrive with very different levels of intent, and their needs change depending on how certain they are about what they want to watch.

Instead of relying on fixed personas, the design focused on understanding decision state. This allowed us to adapt the experience based on user intent.



Concept - a lightweight decision framework

The concept evolved through multiple explorations focused on one goal: helping users move from uncertainty to choice with minimal effort.

Rather than adding more filters or complexity, the design focused on guiding decisions through lightweight, statement-based interactions.

I want to watch

Action

set in

Ancient Rome

from the

2000's

Exploration

Early concepts explored structured filtering and additional choices to understand how much control users wanted versus how much guidance they needed.

Let's find **science fiction movies & tv shows** that are **under 2 hours** and released **after 2020**

Shuffle

Edit

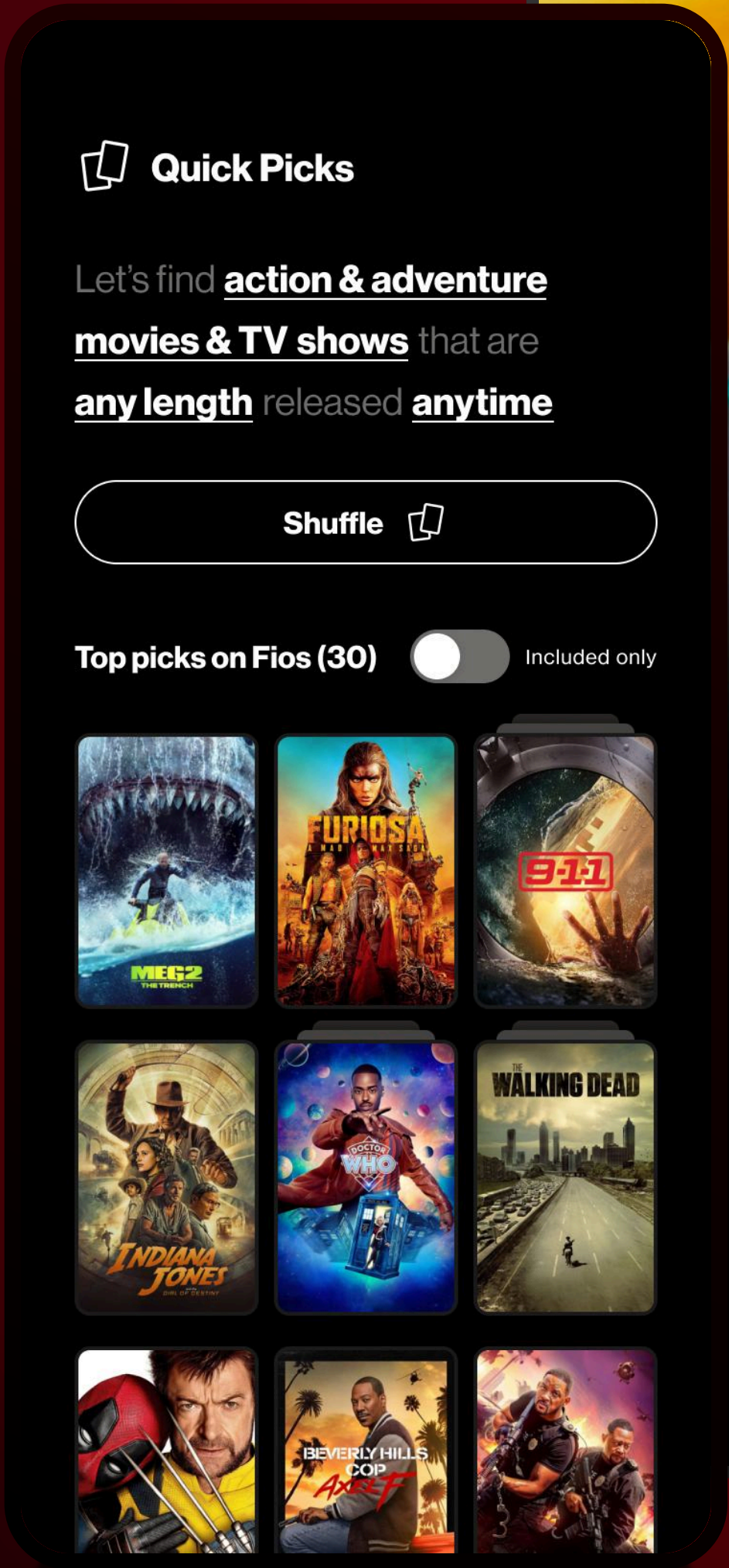
Direction chosen

Testing and concept evaluation showed users responded better to simple, human-readable statements than complex filtering flows.

Designed once. Adapted intentionally across platforms.

Quick Picks was designed as a single product concept, but each platform required different interaction patterns based on how people engage with it.

TV (remote-first)	Mobile (touch-first)
Interaction model: Focus-based navigation • Reduced interaction steps to minimise remote input • Larger, decision-focused layouts • Momentum toward playback Key principle: Reduce effort from the sofa.	Interaction model: Direct manipulation • Faster refinement through tap interactions • Compact decision flows • Designed for short attention windows Key principle: Fast decisions on the go.



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 **Shuffle**

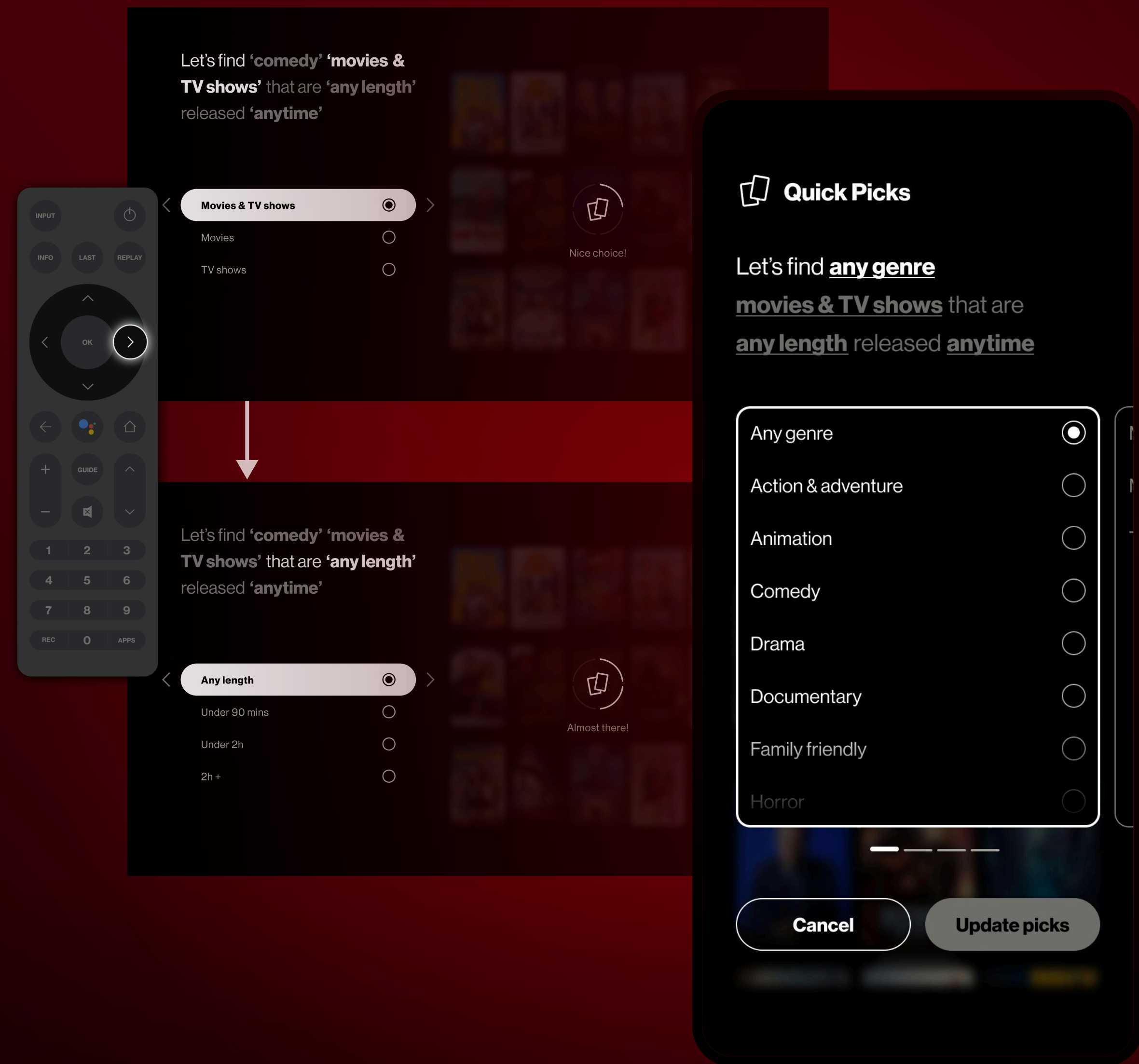
Edit

Iteration - prototyping, testing and refinement

- Built interactive prototypes to test decision flow and interaction clarity
- Used hypothesis-led testing to validate assumptions about user behaviour
- Refined micro-interactions to maintain momentum
- Worked closely with engineering to ensure performance and feasibility

Key learnings

- Users preferred faster narrowing over deeper exploration
- Reducing steps had more impact than adding recommendations
- Clear progress cues increased confidence in decisions



Outcome - a new discovery pattern for faster decisions

User impact

- Reduced effort required to choose content
- Shifted discovery toward faster decision making
- Lower cognitive load compared to traditional browsing

Product impact

- Established a reusable discovery interaction model
- Enabled consistent behaviour across TV, mobile and web
- Created a foundation for future discovery experiments

Team impact

- Improved alignment between design and engineering
- Helped validate iterative, hypothesis-led feature development
- Demonstrated how lightweight experiences can drive engagement

Selected work

Short snapshots of additional product work delivered across enterprise, media and consumer ecosystems.





Partnering with Apple to deliver a best-in-class iOS product for Cisco Webex

Designed a fully native iOS experience for Cisco's Webex app, working directly with Apple's Experience team (who rely on Webex internally) to set a new standard for enterprise communication.

- Hands-on UI design, building scalable component libraries
- Delivered a polished experience in just two months
- Collaborated with Cisco stakeholders and Apple's UX team to define best practices

[Learn more](#) about Webex for iPad.

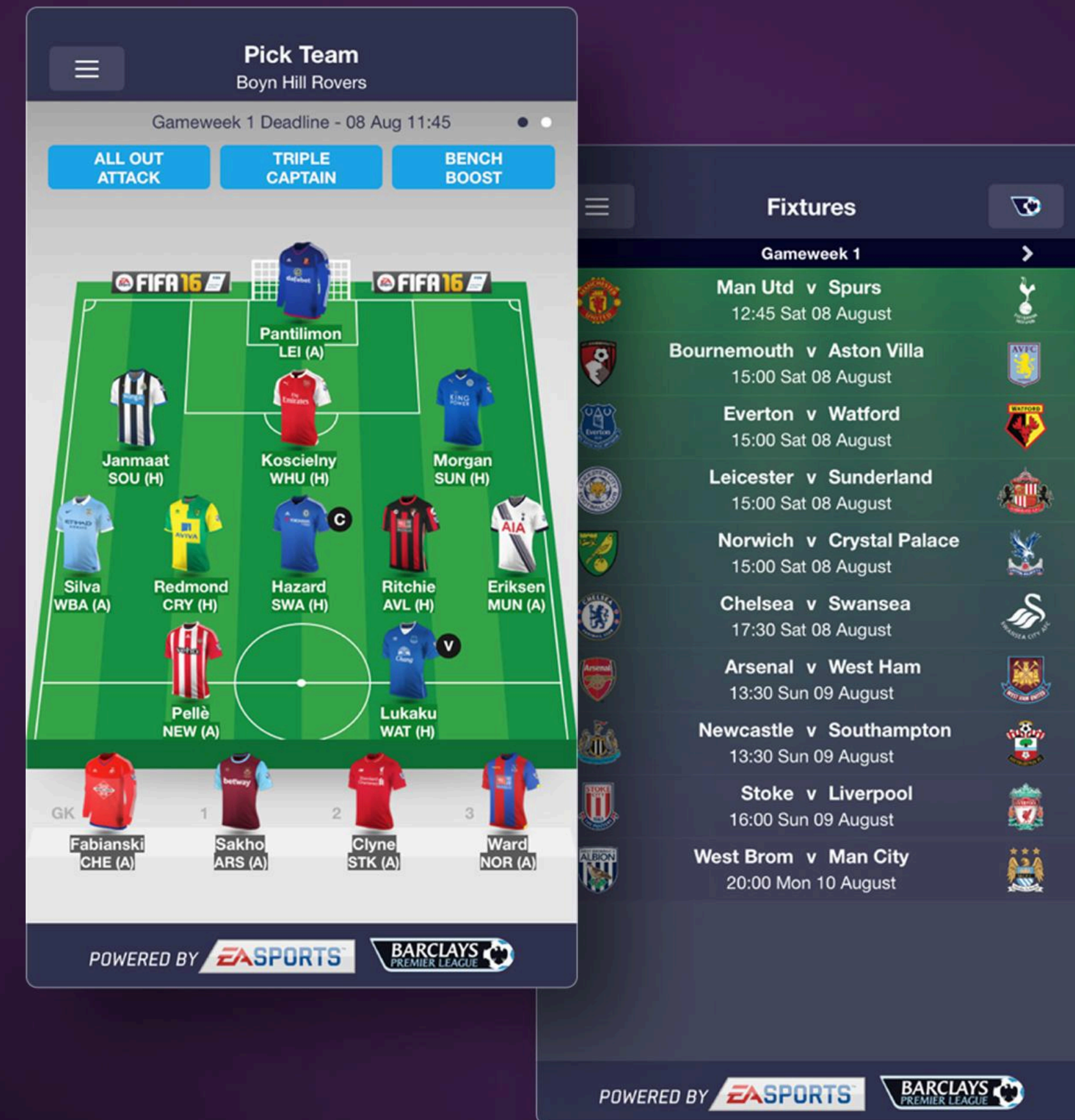




Delivering four consecutive chart-topping seasons for Fantasy Premier League

As the sole product designer, I owned the end-to-end design process and worked directly with the development agency to bring Fantasy Premier League to life across multiple platforms.

- Designed the first ever mobile version of the game
- Delivered experiences across iOS, Android and Windows (mobile, tablet, watch, desktop)
- Owned the entire end-to-end design process, from UX flows to final UI and QA
- Reached 4M+ players each season, topping the app charts



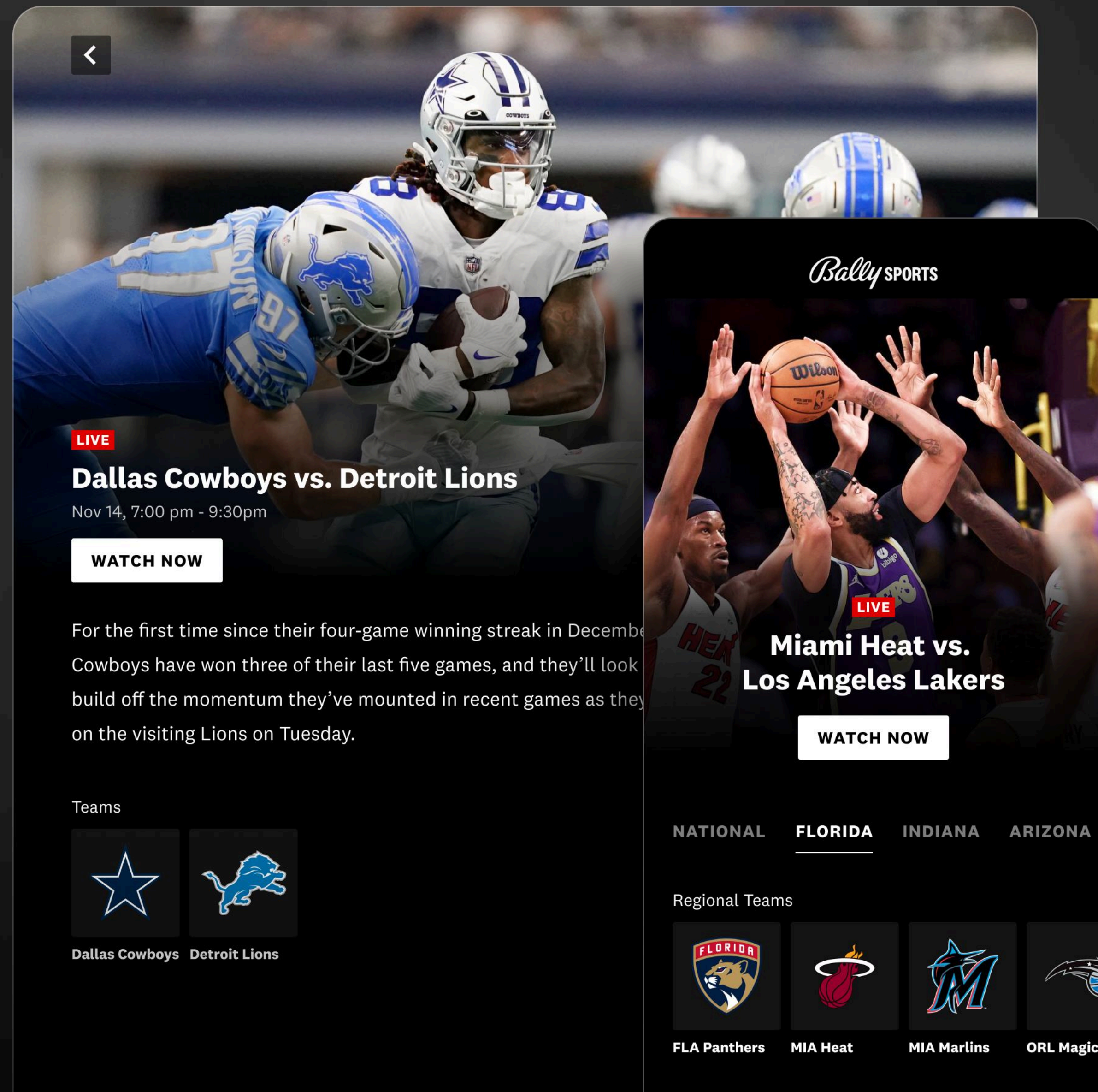


Redesigning the fan experience for Bally Sports across web, mobile, and TV

When Bally Sports acquired Fox Sports, the product ecosystem needed to be rebuilt across web, mobile and TV.

I worked across product and engineering teams to define core fan journeys and design a unified experience that could scale across platforms while supporting rapid delivery.

The platform achieved 10M+ downloads within the first two years.

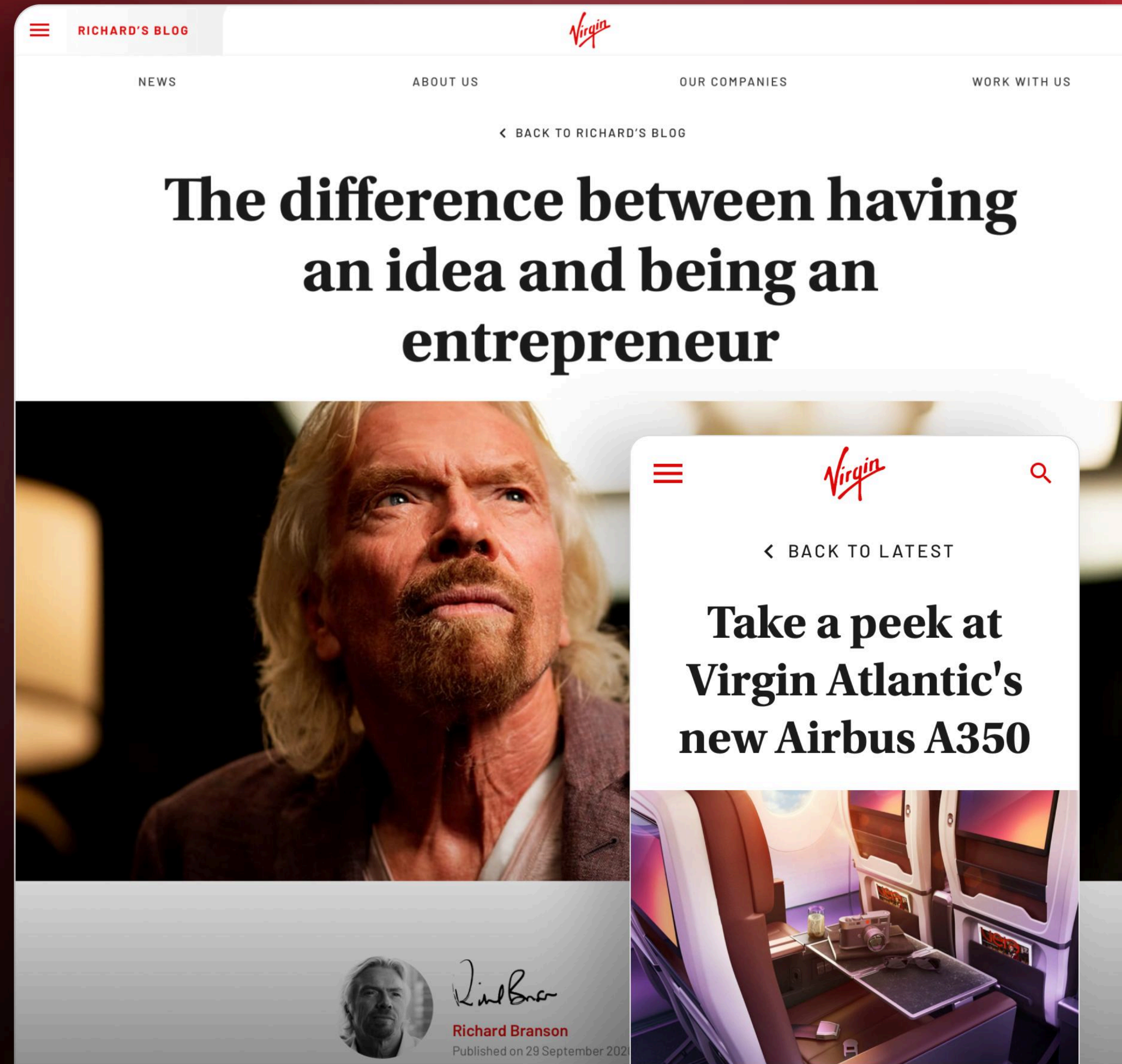




Creating a new digital home for the Virgin Group

At Foolproof, I was part of the team redesigning Virgin.com, creating a modern, scalable home for the Virgin Group. The project involved migrating large editorial archives and company directories into a new, user-friendly information architecture that worked seamlessly across breakpoints.

- Tackled complex IA challenges
- Designed a responsive experience
- Conducted iterative rounds of user testing



Thank you

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